21-DAY PM MASTERY ROADMAP

From Technical Builder → Top-Tier Product Manager

SHREYASH SRIVASTVA

APM Candidate · AI Products · 0→1 Builder
NASA Winner · 12× Hackathon · 3 PyPI Libraries

PHASE 1
DAYS 1–7
Foundation

PHASE 2
DAYS 8–14
Frameworks & Tools

PHASE 3
DAYS 15–21
Mastery & Interviews

HOW TO USE THIS ROADMAP

- Each day = 60–90 min focused work. No skipping.
- 'LEARN' = consume the material. 'DO' = ship the artefact. Both are mandatory.
- Post every OUTPUT task on LinkedIn. Build in public. Be visible.
- By Day 21 you'll have a live portfolio, a practised interview style, and the PM vocabulary to walk into any interview and own the room.

© Shreyash Srivastva · Not for redistribution

BECOME THE PM THEY FIGHT TO HIRE

THE BIG PICTURE

21 days · 3 phases · 1 goal: get hired as a top-tier PM

TAG LEGEND

THEORY · SKILL · ANALYTICS · FRAMEWORKS · CRAFT · PROCESS · OUTPUT · STRATEGY · SOFT SKILL · SPECIALISATION · INTERVIEW · LAUNCH

WEEKLY BREAKDOWN

WK 1
DAYS 1–7

PHASE 1: FOUNDATION

1. PM Mindset & vocabulary
2. User Research + JTBD
3. Product Metrics (AARRR, North Star)
4. Prioritization (RICE, ICE, MoSCoW)
5. Writing your first PRD
6. Agile & Scrum in practice
7. Week review + publish reflection on LinkedIn

WK 2
DAYS 8–14

PHASE 2: FRAMEWORKS & TOOLS

1. Product Strategy & OKRs
2. Roadmapping (Now/Next/Later)
3. UX + Figma for PMs
4. Data & A/B Testing
5. Stakeholder Management
6. AI Product Management (your edge)
7. Week review + publish reflection on LinkedIn

WK 3
DAYS 15–21

PHASE 3: MASTERY & INTERVIEWS

1. Interview: Product Design questions
2. Interview: Metrics questions
3. Interview: Strategy questions
4. Interview: Behavioural (STAR)
5. GTM & Launch Strategy
6. Build your PM portfolio
7. Mock interviews + Job application blitz

BY DAY 21 YOU WILL HAVE:

A public portfolio · A practiced interview style · PM vocabulary · 10+ applications out · Referral pipeline active

DAY 1

THEORY

THE PM MINDSET

What does a PM actually do every day? Unlearn engineer mode.

LEARN

- PM vs Engineer: you own the why, not just the how
- The 3 PM hats: user advocate, business owner, tech translator
- Read: Lenny Rachitsky — 'What is a PM?' (free newsletter)
- Watch: 'Day in the life of a PM' — Exponent YouTube (30 min)

DO TODAY:

Write a 200-word answer to: 'Why do you want to be a PM?' Save it.

RESOURCES: lennysnewsletter.com · youtube.com/@exponentpm

DAY 2

SKILL

USER RESEARCH 101

Every great product starts with deeply understanding users.

LEARN

- Jobs To Be Done (JTBD) framework — what 'job' is the user hiring your product for?
- User interview structure: 5 whys, open-ended questions, avoid leading
- Personas vs JTBD — when to use each
- Read: 'The Mom Test' summary (key chapters, free online summaries)

DO TODAY:

Pick one of your shipped apps. Write 3 JTBD statements for its core users.

RESOURCES: momtestbook.com · nngroup.com/articles/user-interviews

DAY 3

ANALYTICS

PRODUCT METRICS

You can't improve what you don't measure. Learn the PM number language.

LEARN

- Acquisition → Activation → Retention → Revenue → Referral (AARRR)
- DAU, MAU, DAU/MAU ratio, churn rate, NPS, CSAT
- North Star Metric: what single number best captures your product's value?
- Read: Amplitude's 'Product Metrics Guide' (free PDF)

DO TODAY:

For BaggPackers or JobsnVisa — define: North Star Metric, 3 supporting metrics, and 1 guardrail metric.

RESOURCES: amplitude.com/blog/product-metrics · mixpanel.com/blog

DAY 4

FRAMEWORKS

PRIORITIZATION FRAMEWORKS

PMs say no more than yes. Master how to prioritize ruthlessly.

LEARN

- RICE: Reach × Impact × Confidence ÷ Effort
- ICE Score: Impact × Confidence × Ease
- MoSCoW: Must-have, Should-have, Could-have, Won't-have
- Opportunity Scoring (Importance vs Satisfaction gap)

DO TODAY:

Take 5 real features you built or ideas you had. Score them using RICE. Which wins?

RESOURCES: intercom.com/blog/rice-simple-prioritization · productplan.com

DAY 5

CRAFT

WRITING A PRD

The PRD is your product bible. Learn to write specs engineers respect.

LEARN

- PRD structure: Problem → Users → Goals → Success Metrics → User Stories → Scope → Out of Scope
- User story format: As a [user], I want [action], so that [outcome]
- Acceptance criteria: what 'done' looks like, not how to build it
- Read: Shreyas Doshi on 'Good vs Great PRDs' (Twitter/X thread)

DO TODAY:

Write a 1-page PRD for BaggPackers or Tutor.ai. Use the structure above.

RESOURCES: notion.so/templates (PRD template) · docs.google.com

DAY 6

PROCESS

AGILE & SCRUM IN PRACTICE

Understand the ceremonies and artefacts your eng team lives by.

LEARN

- Scrum: Sprint planning, Daily standup, Sprint review, Retrospective
- Kanban: continuous flow, WIP limits, cycle time
- Backlog grooming: how to write, order, and refine tickets
- Story points vs time estimates — why PMs prefer story points

DO TODAY:

Set up a free Linear or Trello board. Create a 5-story backlog for one of your projects.

RESOURCES: linear.app (free) · scrum.org/resources/scrum-guide

DAY 7

OUTPUT

WEEK 1 REVIEW + PORTFOLIO

Consolidate. Create your first public PM artefact.

LEARN

- Review all 6 days' notes — what concepts feel shaky?
- Re-read your PRD from Day 5 and improve it
- Watch: 'Product Teardown' — how to think about any app like a PM

DO TODAY:

Publish your PRD or a product teardown on LinkedIn. Title: 'My first PM PRD — [app name]'. Tag 3 PMs.

RESOURCES: linkedin.com · exponent.fyi/resources

DAY 8

STRATEGY

PRODUCT STRATEGY & VISION

Great PMs think 18 months ahead. Learn to build a product strategy.

LEARN

- Product vision vs strategy vs roadmap — the hierarchy
- OKRs: Objectives + Key Results — how PMs set and track goals
- Market sizing: TAM (Total Addressable Market), SAM, SOM
- Competitive positioning: differentiation, moats, substitutes

DO TODAY:

Write a 6-month product strategy for one of your apps. Include 2 OKRs with 3 KRs each.

RESOURCES: svpg.com/articles · reforge.com/blog (free articles)

DAY 9

CRAFT

ROADMAPPING

A roadmap is a communication tool, not a promise. Learn to build one.

LEARN

- Now/Next/Later roadmap vs quarterly roadmap — when to use each
- Theme-based roadmaps vs feature-based — why themes win
- How to say no to stakeholders (the 'not now, here's why' framework)
- Read: 'Roadmaps are not project plans' — Melissa Perri

DO TODAY:

Build a Now/Next/Later roadmap for BaggPackers in Notion or Miro (free).

RESOURCES: miro.com (free) · prodpad.com/blog

DAY 10

SKILL

UX & FIGMA FOR PMS

PMs don't design, but they must be able to read and critique designs.

LEARN

- Design principles: hierarchy, contrast, affordance, feedback
- Figma: frames, components, auto-layout, prototyping (you already know this — deepen it)
- How to give useful design feedback: behaviour vs aesthetics
- Usability heuristics: Nielsen's 10 — memorise these

DO TODAY:

Open one of your old Figma files. Apply Nielsen's heuristics. List 3 UX issues you'd now fix.

RESOURCES: nngroup.com/articles/ten-usability-heuristics · figma.com/community

DAY 11

ANALYTICS

DATA & A/B TESTING

Evidence beats opinions. Learn to run and read product experiments.

LEARN

- A/B test anatomy: hypothesis, control, variant, sample size, significance
- Statistical significance — what $p < 0.05$ actually means for PMs
- Multivariate testing, feature flags, and gradual rollouts
- Common pitfalls: peeking problem, novelty effect, Simpson's paradox

DO TODAY:

Design a hypothetical A/B test for your AI chatbot (which CTA copy drives more clicks?).

RESOURCES: statsig.com/blog · optimizely.com/optimization-glossary

DAY 12

SOFT SKILL

STAKEHOLDER MANAGEMENT

PMs have authority over nothing and responsibility for everything.
Influence is survival.

LEARN

- RACI matrix: Responsible, Accountable, Consulted, Informed
- Managing up: how to present to executives (BLUF — Bottom Line Up Front)
- Managing across: aligning with design, engineering, marketing, sales
- Handling conflict: disagree and commit, escalation paths

DO TODAY:

Write a 5-sentence 'executive summary' of one of your projects. Lead with the outcome, not the process.

RESOURCES: hbr.org/topic/subject/stakeholder-management · lethain.com (Will Larson)

DAY 13

SPECIALISATION

AI PRODUCT MANAGEMENT

This is your unfair advantage. Go deeper than anyone else on AI PM skills.

LEARN

- AI product-specific challenges: hallucinations, latency, explainability, feedback loops
- Evaluating AI features: offline evals vs online metrics, human-in-loop
- Prompt engineering for PMs: how to spec AI behaviour without writing code
- Responsible AI: bias, privacy, fairness — what PMs must own

DO TODAY:

Write a 1-page 'AI Feature Spec' for a new AI feature in one of your apps. Include failure modes.

RESOURCES: a16z.com/ai · huggingface.co/blog · anthropic.com/research

DAY 14

OUTPUT

WEEK 2 REVIEW + PRODUCT TEARDOWN

Synthesise week 2. Produce a public product teardown.

LEARN

- Product teardown framework: What is it? Who is it for? How does it make money? What would you change?
- Pick an AI app you use daily (Notion AI, Perplexity, Claude, etc.)
- Analyse: onboarding, core loop, monetisation, growth, missing features

DO TODAY:

Publish a 400-word product teardown on LinkedIn. Include a roadmap suggestion. Share in PM communities.

RESOURCES: producthunt.com · reddit.com/r/ProductManagement

DAY 15

INTERVIEW

PM INTERVIEW: PRODUCT DESIGN

Design a product for X — the most common PM interview question type.

LEARN

- Framework: Clarify → User segments → Pick segment → Pain points → Solutions → Prioritise → Metrics → Tradeoffs
- Always start with the user, not the feature
- Common prompts: 'Design a product for blind users', 'Improve Google Maps'
- Watch: 5 product design mock interviews on Exponent YouTube

DO TODAY:

Answer out loud: 'Design a product for senior citizens in rural India.' Time yourself — 10 minutes.

RESOURCES: youtube.com/@exponentpm · tryexponent.com/practice

DAY 16

INTERVIEW

PM INTERVIEW: METRICS

How would you measure success of X? Answer with confidence.

LEARN

- Framework: Goal → Define success → Pick metrics → Segment → Tradeoffs → North Star
- Diagnosing metric drops: internal vs external, correlation vs causation
- Common prompts: 'Facebook likes are down 10% — investigate', 'How do you measure WhatsApp?'

DO TODAY:

Answer: 'How would you measure the success of Tutor.ai?' Write a full structured answer.

RESOURCES: stellarpeers.com · productmanagementexercises.com

DAY 17

INTERVIEW

PM INTERVIEW: STRATEGY

Should company X enter market Y? Think like a CEO.

LEARN

- Framework: Market attractiveness → Competitive position → Strategic fit → Recommendation
- Porter's 5 Forces — use it briefly, don't get stuck in it
- Common prompts: 'Should Spotify launch a podcast creation tool?', 'Should Google enter healthcare?'
- Always give a clear recommendation with 3 reasons. PMs who hedge fail.

DO TODAY:

Answer: 'Should Anthropic launch a product for schools?' Structure your full response.

RESOURCES: caseinterview.com · hackingthecaseinterview.com

DAY 18

INTERVIEW

PM INTERVIEW: BEHAVIOURAL

Tell me about a time… — your real stories, told with PM language.

LEARN

- STAR method: Situation, Task, Action, Result
- Map your experiences to PM competencies: leadership, data-driven decisions, conflict, shipping under constraints
- Must-have stories: time you shipped something, time you failed, time you influenced without authority
- Your NASA win = perfect 'shipped under constraints + cross-functional' story

DO TODAY:

Write STAR answers for 5 behavioural questions. Read them aloud until smooth.

RESOURCES: levels.fyi/blog · igotanoffer.com/blogs/pm

DAY 19

STRATEGY

GTM & LAUNCH STRATEGY

Shipping is half the job. Launching well is the other half.

LEARN

- GTM checklist: pricing, positioning, channel strategy, launch tiers (GA vs beta vs early access)
- Launch metrics: activation rate, D1/D7/D30 retention, referral rate
- PM's role in marketing: positioning doc, messaging hierarchy, ICP (Ideal Customer Profile)
- Post-launch: how to run a retrospective and feed learnings back into roadmap

DO TODAY:

Write a 1-page GTM plan for relaunching JobsnVisa to a new market (e.g. Canada or UK).

RESOURCES: firstround.com/review · go.forsta.com/gtm-guide

DAY 20

OUTPUT

YOUR PM PORTFOLIO

Assemble everything. Your portfolio IS your application.

LEARN

- Portfolio must-haves: PRD, product teardown, roadmap, case study of one shipped product
- Notion portfolio vs personal site — Notion is faster, site is more impressive
- LinkedIn optimisation: headline, about section, featured section with artefacts
- Cold email template for APM roles — personalise the first line always

DO TODAY:

Publish your Notion portfolio with 3 artefacts. Update LinkedIn headline. Send 5 cold emails.

RESOURCES: notion.site (free) · peerlist.io (Indian PM community)

DAY 21

LAUNCH

MOCK INTERVIEWS + JOB BLITZ

You are ready. Today you go live.

LEARN

- Do 2 full mock interviews — use Exponent or find a practice partner on Reddit r/ProductManagement
- Record yourself. Watch back. Fix filler words and hedging.
- Set up job alerts on Wellfound, LinkedIn, Instahyre, Naukri, and Peerlist
- Track applications in a Notion table: Company | Role | Status | Follow-up date

DO TODAY:

Apply to 10 roles today. Send 5 cold emails. Post your Day 21 reflection on LinkedIn.

RESOURCES: wellfound.com · peerlist.io · linkedin.com/jobs

MASTER RESOURCE LIST

Everything you need, organised by category

BOOKS

Cracking the PM Interview
Gayle McDowell & Jackie Bavaro — interview prep bible

The Mom Test
Rob Fitzpatrick — user research that doesn't lie to you

Inspired
Marty Cagan — how Silicon Valley product teams work

Continuous Discovery Habits
Teresa Torres — modern product discovery

Measure What Matters
John Doerr — OKRs in practice

TOOLS TO LEARN

linear.app
Modern backlog / sprint tool — free personal plan

miro.com
Roadmaps, user journey maps, retros — free tier

amplitude.com
Product analytics — free for small projects

notion.so
PRD writing, portfolio, roadmaps — free

figma.com
You already know this — now use it for PM artefacts

COMMUNITIES

peerlist.io
Best Indian PM community. Post your portfolio here.

reddit.com/r/ProductManagement
Practice Q&A, job hunting, honest advice

lennyslack.com
Lenny Rachitsky's Slack — premium but worth it

producthunt.com
Study launches, read comments, understand GTM

GDG (your existing network)
Start here. DM 10 people this week.

"THE BEST PMS SHIP THINGS. YOU ALREADY DO. NOW LEARN THE LANGUAGE."

Your technical edge + PM vocabulary = a candidate most companies have never seen.